

C855

Nursing Informatics Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

An informatics nurse at a hospital that recently hosted a regional conference has just led a successful go-live of an optimized discharge-education module. The project sponsor, who is retiring next year, says the project is finished. According to the SDLC, what remains?

- A. Maintenance, support, and evaluation: monitor performance, fix issues, and measure outcomes against objectives.
- B. Begin a new planning phase immediately.
- C. Plan to replace the module when the sponsor retires.
- D. Nothing; the SDLC ends at go-live.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

Twelve months after go-live, an informatics nurse at a clinic network with a new mobile app compares the handoff error rate against the pre-implementation baseline and the project's stated objective. Clinic staff recently completed annual compliance training. What type of evaluation is this?

- A. A needs assessment.
- B. Formative evaluation.
- C. Summative evaluation.
- D. User acceptance testing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

During the first two weeks after go-live, a team gathers daily feedback and fixes screen issues as they come up to improve the rollout. What type of evaluation is this?

- A. Outcome evaluation.
- B. Formative evaluation.
- C. Summative evaluation.
- D. Cost-benefit analysis.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

Three months after go-live, a charge nurse on a unit known for its strong teamwork asks the analyst to add a required field to the discharge screen “today.” The analyst has administrative rights in the live system, and the unit is short-staffed this week. What is the right process?

- A. Log the request, assess impact, build and test outside production, get approval, then move it to production.
- B. Make the change directly in the live system, since the analyst has rights.
- C. Refuse all changes after go-live.
- D. Wait until staffing improves.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

After go-live at a four-hospital system with a new CEO, a night-shift nurse cannot find the new education flowsheet. A trained super user is working on the unit, and the vendor offers a 24-hour support line. What is the best first level of support?

- A. Chart on paper and skip the flowsheet.
- B. Ask the super user on the unit.
- C. Escalate straight to the CIO.
- D. Call the vendor’s 24-hour line.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

An informatics nurse at a hospital that recently repaved its parking lot builds a dashboard to monitor a fall-prevention optimization. It includes the percentage of patients with a completed fall-risk assessment each shift. The dashboard is shown on a large screen at the nurses’ station. What kind of indicator is this?

- A. A leading (process) indicator.
- B. Not an indicator, because it is shown on a screen instead of a report.
- C. A lagging (outcome) indicator.
- D. A structure measure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

For the same fall-prevention program, which is a lagging indicator?

- A.** Percentage of fall-risk assessments completed.
- B.** Number of dashboard views per week.
- C.** Falls with injury per 1,000 patient days.
- D.** Number of bed alarms available per unit.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

During the maintenance phase of a discharge-module project at a hospital that won a design award for its new tower, physicians ask to add a medication-refill feature. The informatics nurse has spare time this month. How should the request be handled?

- A.** Add it to the original project's objectives after the fact.
- B.** Build it now while there is spare time.
- C.** Reject it, because maintenance never includes enhancements.
- D.** Send it through governance to be prioritized as a new enhancement request.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A system optimization at a hospital with a new rehab gym cost \$80,000 to build and support in year one. It avoided an estimated \$200,000 in readmission penalties and overtime. The project team had 7 members. What is the first-year ROI?

- A.** \$120,000
- B.** 250%
- C.** 40%
- D.** 150%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project costs \$50,000 and must return a 60% ROI. What total benefit must it produce?

- A.** \$60,000
- B.** \$83,333
- C.** \$80,000
- D.** \$30,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

After go-live at an academic hospital that recently added a new helipad, the informatics nurse is asked how to make sure only staff involved in a patient's care can view the new discharge module and how improper access will be caught. The module runs on a cloud platform. Which pair of controls fits best?

- A.** Give everyone full access and rely on annual training.
- B.** Move the module off the cloud platform.
- C.** Encrypt the data, so no audit is needed.
- D.** Role-based access control plus regular audit-log review.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An audit log shows a nurse opened the record of a patient on another unit to whom she was not assigned. What does the log provide, and what comes next?

- A.** Proof of guilt requiring immediate firing.
- B.** Evidence of possible inappropriate access, to be investigated under privacy policy.
- C.** Prevention of the access.
- D.** Nothing; logs are only for IT troubleshooting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

An informatics nurse at a hospital ~~that recently hosted a regional conference~~ has just led a successful go-live of an optimized discharge-education module. The project sponsor, ~~who is retiring next year,~~ says the project is finished. According to the SDLC, what remains?

Target word: what follows go-live **Decides:** The maintenance, support, and evaluation phase has not started.

A	Correct	The final SDLC phase continues after go-live.
B	Inverted operation	Jumps back to the start before evaluating what was built.
C	Camouflage	The sponsor's retirement does not set the system's life cycle.
D	Dropped element	Drops the final phase.

2. Answer C Concept 2

Twelve months after go-live, an informatics nurse at a clinic network ~~with a new mobile app~~ compares the handoff error rate against the pre-implementation baseline and the project's stated objective. ~~Clinic staff recently completed annual compliance training.~~ What type of evaluation is this?

Target word: type of evaluation **Decides:** Judging results against baseline and objectives after implementation.

A	Adjacent category	Needs assessment comes before a project to define the problem.
B	Confusion set	Formative evaluation adjusts the work while it is under way.
C	Correct	It judges the final outcome against objectives.
D	Inverted operation	UAT happens before go-live, not a year after.

3. Answer B Concept 2 · transfer

During the first two weeks after go-live, a team gathers daily feedback and fixes screen issues as they come up to improve the rollout. What type of evaluation is this?

Target word: type of evaluation — reversed **Decides:** Improving the work while it is in progress.

A	Confusion set	No outcomes are being judged yet.
B	Correct	Ongoing feedback used to improve is formative.
C	Inverted operation	Summative judges final results.
D	Adjacent category	That compares dollars, not rollout feedback.

4. Answer A Concept 3

Three months after go-live, a charge nurse on a unit ~~known for its strong teamwork~~ asks the analyst to add a required field to the discharge screen "today." The analyst has administrative rights in the live system, ~~and the unit is short staffed this week.~~ What is the right process?

Target word: how to change production **Decides:** Changes to a live system follow change control.

A	Correct	Change control protects the live system from untested changes.
B	Dropped element	Skips testing and approval.
C	Absolute language	Systems need controlled changes to stay useful.
D	Camouflage	Staffing does not decide the process.

5. Answer B Concept 4

After go-live at a four-hospital system ~~with a new CEO~~, a night-shift nurse cannot find the new education flowsheet. A trained super user is working on the unit, ~~and the vendor offers a 24-hour support line~~. What is the best first level of support?

Target word: first-line support **Decides:** A how-to question with a trained super user present.

A	Adjacent category	Downtime paper is for outages, not how-to questions.
B	Correct	Super users are the first tier for workflow questions.
C	Inverted operation	Starts at the top of the escalation path.
D	Camouflage	Vendor support is a later escalation tier.

6. Answer A Concept 5

An informatics nurse at a hospital ~~that recently repaved its parking lot~~ builds a dashboard to monitor a fall-prevention optimization. It includes the percentage of patients with a completed fall-risk assessment each shift. ~~The dashboard is shown on a large screen at the nurses' station~~. What kind of indicator is this?

Target word: classify indicator **Decides:** Tracks an action that drives results.

A	Correct	Assessment completion predicts and drives fall outcomes.
B	Camouflage	Display method does not change what is measured.
C	Confusion set	Outcome indicators measure the falls themselves.
D	Adjacent category	Structure covers resources, such as staffing or equipment.

7. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

For the same fall-prevention program, which is a lagging indicator?

Target word: identify lagging **Decides:** A result that shows after the fact.

A	Inverted operation	That is the leading indicator.
B	Confusion set	Measures use of the tool, not patient outcomes.
C	Correct	Harm rates are outcomes measured after the fact.
D	Adjacent category	That is a structure measure.

8. Answer D Concept 6

During the maintenance phase of a discharge-module project at a hospital ~~that won a design award for its new tower~~, physicians ask to add a medication-refill feature. ~~The informatics nurse has spare time this month~~. How should the request be handled?

Target word: handle a new feature request **Decides:** It is a new enhancement, not part of the current scope.

A	Adjacent category	Rewrites the baseline project instead of managing a new request.
B	Camouflage	Available time does not authorize scope changes.
C	Absolute language	Enhancements can be approved through governance.
D	Correct	Governance weighs value, risk, and resources for new work.

9. Answer D Concept 7

A system optimization at a hospital ~~with a new rehab gym~~ cost \$80,000 to build and support in year one. It avoided an estimated \$200,000 in readmission penalties and overtime. ~~The project team had 7 members.~~ What is the first-year ROI?

Target word: ROI **Decides:** $(\$200,000 - \$80,000) / \$80,000$.

A	Adjacent category	That is net benefit in dollars, not a return rate.
B	Dropped element	Divides benefit by cost without subtracting the cost.
C	Inverted operation	Divides cost by benefit.
D	Correct	$\$120,000 / \$80,000 = 1.5 = 150\%$.

10. Answer C Concept 7 · transfer

A project costs \$50,000 and must return a 60% ROI. What total benefit must it produce?

Target word: solve for benefit **Decides:** $\text{Benefit} = \text{cost} \times (1 + \text{ROI})$.

A	Wrong stem number	Treats the 60% as dollars in thousands.
B	Inverted operation	Divides cost by 0.6.
C	Correct	$\$50,000 \times 1.6 = \$80,000$; $(\$80,000 - \$50,000) / \$50,000 = 60\%$.
D	Dropped element	That is the net gain, not total benefit.

11. Answer D Concept 8

After go-live at an academic hospital ~~that recently added a new helipad~~, the informatics nurse is asked how to make sure only staff involved in a patient's care can view the new discharge module and how improper access will be caught. ~~The module runs on a cloud platform.~~ Which pair of controls fits best?

Target word: prevent and detect access **Decides:** One preventive and one detective control are needed.

A	Dropped element	Drops both technical controls.
B	Camouflage	Hosting location does not decide who views records.
C	Adjacent category	Encryption protects data at rest and in transit, not against misuse by authorized users.
D	Correct	RBAC limits access; audit logs detect misuse.

12. Answer B Concept 8 · transfer

An audit log shows a nurse opened the record of a patient on another unit to whom she was not assigned. What does the log provide, and what comes next?

Target word: role of audit logs **Decides:** Logs are detective, not preventive.

A	Absolute language	Access must be investigated before action.
B	Correct	Logs detect access for follow-up; there may be a valid reason, so policy guides the review.
C	Inverted operation	Logs record after the fact; they do not block.
D	Adjacent category	Access logs are a core privacy control.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The SDLC does not end at go-live	The final phase — maintenance, support, and evaluation — monitors the system, fixes issues, and measures outcomes against objectives.	Treating go-live as the end of the project.	A sponsor declares the project “finished” right after go-live.
2	Formative vs. summative evaluation	Formative evaluation happens during rollout to improve it; summative evaluation judges results against baseline and objectives after implementation.	Calling any post-go-live review summative.	Timing and purpose: improving as you go vs. judging the result.
3	Change control	Production changes are logged, assessed for impact, built and tested outside production, approved, then moved in.	Making a quick change directly in the live system.	An urgent request and an analyst with live-system access.
4	Tiered support	First-line support is the trained super user at the elbow; issues escalate to the help desk, analysts, then the vendor.	Going straight to the vendor or to leadership.	A how-to question with a super user nearby.
5	Leading vs. lagging indicators	Leading (process) indicators track actions that drive results and can be acted on early; lagging (outcome) indicators show results after the fact.	Calling a completion rate an outcome.	“Percentage completed” vs. “rate of harm.”
6	Governance of new requests	New feature requests during maintenance go through governance for prioritization as enhancements, not quietly added to current scope.	Building requests because someone has spare time.	A feature request after go-live.
7	Return on investment	$ROI = (\text{benefit} - \text{cost}) / \text{cost}$.	Dividing benefit by cost without subtracting, or dividing cost by benefit.	A project cost and a dollar benefit.
8	Access control and audit	Role-based access limits who can see data (preventive); audit logs reveal inappropriate access after it happens (detective) for follow-up under policy.	Thinking logs prevent access, or that encryption replaces auditing.	“Only those involved in care” and “detect improper access.”

Course scope (public description): Nursing Informatics Capstone requires students to complete clinical/practice experiences (CPE) and finalize their system optimization proposal paper, which addresses the Institute of Health’s Triple Aim initiative. During this course, students will plan the final phase of their system development life cycle (SDLC), which consists of proposing the processes, methods, and tasks for monitoring, maintaining, supporting, and evaluating their system optimization. The knowledge and skills that students acquire during the CPE in this course will prepare them to complete their system optimization proposal paper. This is a culminating course that provides students an opportunity to demonstrate the competencies acquired during this program. All MSN Core and Specialty courses, including the Field Experience course, are prerequisites to this course and must be completed before taking this course. This course is eligible for an In Progress grade. Please see the Grading Scale

Policy for more information.